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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PORTFOLIO, PLASTIC

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers non-expanding (envelope) plastic portfolios, and expanding plastic portfolios with or without handles.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. Portfolios covered by this specification shall be of the following types and classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I. - Non-expanding (envelope).
  Class 1. - Plastic slide-fastener.
  Class 2. - Metal slide-fastener.

Type II. - Expanding.
  Class 1. - With handle.
  Class 2. - Without handle.

1.2.2 Sizes. Portfolios shall be of the sizes stated in 3.2.1.2 and 3.2.2.2, as specified (see 6.2).

1.2.3 Colors. Portfolios shall be of the colors stated in 3.2.1.3 and 3.2.2.3, as specified (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

V-F-106 - Fasteners, Slide, Interlocking.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Method.
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406 - Plastics: Methods of Testing.
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards, and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Method of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions shall be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.

2.2 Other publication. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

Standard Methods of Tests.

D 792-66 - Tests for Specific Gravity and Density of Plastics by Displacement.
D 882-64T - Tests for Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting (Tentative).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1616 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

Chemical Fabrics and Film Association.

Standard Test Methods.

Cold Resistance Test.

(Copies of Standard Test Methods may be obtained from the Chemical Fabrics and Film Association, 60 E. 42nd Street, New York, NY 10017.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials and components.

3.1.1 Base material. The base material shall be virgin polyvinyl chloride plastic sheeting or virgin polyvinyl chloride plastic coated woven or knitted cloth with the physical properties shown in table I, when tested as specified in 4.4.2. The base material shall be nonflammable, or the burning rate shall not exceed 3.0 inches per minute, when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.6.

TABLE I. Physical properties

	Type I	Type II
Thickness, average 1/	Not less than 0.030 inch	Not less than 0.042 inch
Tensile strength, P.S.I., minimum	3,000 (4.4.2.1)	2,200 (4.4.2.1)
Tear resistance, pounds, minimum,		
Machine direction	12 (see 4.4.2.2)	16.5 (see 4.4.2.2)
Transverse direction	9 (see 4.4.2.2)	15.5 (see 4.4.2.2)
Cold resistance	$-10^{\circ} \pm 2^{\circ}$F (see 4.4.2.3)	$-10^{\circ} \pm 2^{\circ}$F (see 4.4.2.3)
Specific gravity	Not more than 1.33 (see 4.4.2.4)	Not more than 1.33 (see 4.4.2.4)

1/ Measurement shall be taken at ten different points of the portfolio. The average thickness shall be as shown above.

3.1.2 Type I, class 1, plastic slide-fastener. The slide fastener shall be an all-plastic interlock extrusion, pull-type slide-fastener, with a 3/4-inch metal tab. The clear opening of the fastener shall be not less than 90 percent of the minimum length of the portfolio specified. The fastener shall be made of clear vinyl plastic capable of withstanding the impact test without impairing the vinyl, when tested at minus 10°F, or less (see 4.4.2.3).

3.1.3 Type I, class 2, metal interlocking slide-fastener. The fastener shall conform to type I, style 18, of V-F-106. The clear opening of the slide-fastener shall be not less than 16-1/4 inches for the "16-3/4 inch by 12 inch size", and not less than 14-1/4 inches for the "14-3/4 inch by 11-3/8 inch size". (See 3.2.1.2.)

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3.1.4 Type II, steel tuck-type fastener. The tuck-type fastener shall be made of steel and shall be electroplated with 0.0003 inch brass. The fastener shall consist of a hasp and a staple.

3.1.5 Type II, class 1, handle. The handle shall be made of vinyl, and of the same color as the body of the portfolio specified. The handle shall be flat, not less than 0.200 inch thick, not less than 8 inches long, and not less than 0.625 inch wide at the narrowest point. When the handle is made of the base material (see 3.1.1), the layers shall be stitched or electronically welded.

3.1.6 Type II, class 1, metal strip. The metal strip shall be made of aluminum or steel. The strip shall be not less than 8-3/8 inches long, 1/2 inch wide, and 1/16 inch thick.

3.2 Design and construction.

3.2.1 Type I - non-expanding (envelope).

3.2.1.1 Body. The body of the portfolio shall conform to the base material requirements specified in 3.1.1 and table I. The portfolio shall be constructed from not more than three pieces of base material. All seams and welds shall be made by high frequency sealing method. The tensile strength of the seams shall be not less than 50 percent of the tensile strength of the base material, when tested as described in 4.4.2.5.

3.2.1.1.1 Slide-fasteners. The slide-fastener shall conform to the requirements stated in 3.1.2 or 3.1.3, as applicable. The center of the slide-fastener shall be located 1-1/4 ± 1/8 inches from the top edge of the portfolio. The area of the vinyl sheeting supporting the slide-fastener shall be extended approximately 5/8 inch on each side beyond the required length of the portfolio to accommodate the length of the slide-fastener. Each inner side of the slide-fastener shall have a weld of not less than 1/4 inch. The junction between the vinyl body and the slide-fastener shall not separate, when subjected to the separation test specified in 4.4.1.2.

3.2.1.2 Dimensions. The portfolios shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

16-3/4 inches by 12 inches.
14-3/4 inches by 11-3/8 inches.

There shall be an allowable tolerance of plus or minus 5/8 inch from both length and width. The body size is exclusive of left and right slide-fastener protrusions.

3.2.1.3 Colors. The colors of the portfolios shall be blue, brown, tan, or black, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1.4 Marking. The following shall be electronically embossed (intaglio) in the middle above the slide-fastener: "Property of the U.S. Government" or "U. S. Government". The following shall be hot stamped or silk screened in contrasting color on the inside back portion of the portfolio: "FSN _____", and insert name or trademark of manufacturer"_____".

3.2.2 Type II - expanding.

3.2.2.1 Body. The body of the portfolio shall conform to the base material requirements specified in 3.1.1 and table I. The body shall be constructed of not more than three pieces of base material. Seams shall be stitched or shall be sealed by high-frequency electronic sealing. Stitched seams shall conform to stitch type 301 or 401 and seam type SSa-1 of FED-STD-No. 751a. All stitched seams shall be covered with cloth or plastic binding. Rivets may be employed on stitched seams to increase the strength of the seams. The seams shall be free from skips, and shall be straight and in good appearance. Free edges shall be embossed to provide a selvage effect. The tensile strength of the seams shall be not less than 50 percent of the tensile strength of the seams shall be not less than 50 percent of the tensile strength of the base material, when tested as described in 4.4.2.5.

3.2.2.1.1 Steel tuck-type fastener. Each portfolio shall be supplied with two fasteners conforming to the requirements specified in 3.1.4. The hasps shall be securely attached to the flap by two rivets, and the staples shall be securely attached to the front of the portfolio. No part of the staple fixture shall be visible from the inside of the portfolio.

3.2.2.1.2 Handle and metal strip. The handle and strip shall conform to the requirements specified in 3.1.5 and 3.1.6, respectively. The strip shall be concealed. The handle shall be located equidistant from the ends of the portfolio, and shall be secured to the strip and flap by two rivets. The handle shall have 1/4 inch lateral movement. The portfolio shall withstand a weight of 60 pounds without break or permanent deformation, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1.

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3.2.2.2 Dimensions. The portfolio, when closed, shall measure 15-1/2 ± 1/4 inches by 11-1/4 ± 1/4 inches. When fully expanded, the sides of the portfolio shall have a minimum expansion of 2 inches (measurements shall be taken approximately 5 inches from the top of the portfolio).

3.2.2.3 Colors. The colors of the portfolios shall be black, brown or tan, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.2.4 Marking. In the center above the hasps, each portfolio shall be electronically embossed (intaglio) with the following:

"Property of the U. S. Government", or
"U. S. Government"
"FSN_____"
"Insert name or trademark of manufacturer _____"

In lieu of electronic embossing, the "FSN" and the name or trademark of the manufacturer may be hot stamped or silk screened in contrasting color on the upper back part of the inside of the portfolio.

3.3 Workmanship. The portfolios shall be free from defects or imperfection which adversely affect appearance, impair serviceability, or constitute a hazard to the users.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All portfolios of the same type, class, size and color presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examination and tests.

4.2.2 Sampling for examinations and tests. Sampling for examinations and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. A random sample of portfolios shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit shall be one portfolio. The portfolio shall be examined for defects listed in table II. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 Sampling for end-item tests. For each test, a random sample of portfolios shall be selected from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The portfolios shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1.1, and 4.4.1.2 as applicable. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, and the AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.6 Sampling for physical properties. One or more portfolios, as needed, shall be taken at random from each lot. Test samples shall be cut from sample portfolio(s), and tested as specified in 4.4.2.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table II. Any portfolio having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

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TABLE II. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Type and class	Not as specified (see 1.2.1).
Material and components	Not as specified (see 3.1 thru 3.1.6, as applicable).
Thickness	Not as specified (see table I).
Design and construction:	
Type I	Not as specified (see 3.2.1, 3.2.1.1, and 3.2.1.1.1).
Type II	Not as specified (see 3.2.2, 3.2.2.1, 3.2.2.1.1, and 3.2.2.1.2, as applicable).
Dimensions	Not as specified (see 3.2.1.2 and 3.2.2.2, as applicable).
Colors	Not as specified (see 3.2.1.3 and 3.2.2.3, as specified).
Marking	Not as specified (see 3.2.1.4 and 3.2.2.4, as applicable).
Workmanship	Not in accordance with 3.3.

4.3.2 Examination for preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be examined for defects listed in table III to determine whether packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Any shipping container having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective boxes exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or not as specified. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as, incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, strapping, improper taping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of containers.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 End item tests. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to the following tests, as applicable. Any portfolio in the sample failing the test shall be considered defective. If the number of defective portfolios exceeds the acceptable number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.1.1 Handle. A uniformly distributed load of 60 pounds shall be placed inside the sample portfolio. With the flap secured by the fasteners, suspend the portfolio by the handle over a support 4-1/2 ± 1/2 inches wide. Allow the portfolio to remain in this position for one hour, and then examine for requirements stated in 3.2.2.1.2.

4.4.1.2 Separation. The junction between the body and the slide-fastener shall withstand a lateral scale pull of 40 pounds with a 1-inch gripper, without separating (see 3.2.1.1.1).

4.4.2 Physical properties tests. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.6 shall be tested for the applicable properties. Failure to pass any one test shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot.

4.4.2.1 Tensile strength. The tensile strength shall be tested in accordance with ASTM Test Standard D-882-64T, to assure compliance with the requirements stated in table I.

4.4.2.2 Tearing strength. The tearing strength shall be tested in accordance with Test Method 5134 of FED-STD-191, to assure compliance with the requirements stated in table I.

4.4.2.3 Cold resistance. The cold resistance shall be tested in accordance with the test specified in Standard Test Method, issued by Chemical Fabrics and Film Association.

4.4.2.4 Specific gravity. The specific gravity shall be tested in accordance with ASTM Test Standard D 792-66, Method A, to assure compliance with requirements stated in table I.

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4.4.2.5 Seam tensile strength. The seam tensile strength shall be tested in accordance with method B of Test Method 1013 of FED-STD-406 to assure compliance with the requirements stated in 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.2.1, as applicable. One specimen shall be cut from each seam. Specimens shall be one inch side, and the seam shall be perpendicular to the longer dimensions of the specimens.

4.4.2.6 Flammability. Cut pieces of base material approximately 3 inches long and 1/2 inch wide from the portfolio(s). In a draft free area hold the material specimen horizontally above a bunsen burner having a 1 to 1-1/4 inch blue flame just touching the end of the specimen until it ignites, or for a period not over 30 seconds. Remove the flame. If the specimen will not support combustion, it is nonflammable. If the specimen burns when in contact with the flame but will not continue to burn when flame is removed, it is flame resistant. If the specimen continues to burn at a rate of 3.0 inches or less, it is slow burning. If the specimen bursts into flame or burns at a rate faster than 3.0 inches per minute it is to be considered as not meeting the requirements of this specification. (See 3.1.1).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I. The portfolios shall be packaged in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, style optional; or to PPP-B-665, style optional; or to PPP-B-676, type optional. The boxes shall be closed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. Each box shall be waterproofed in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-2.

5.1.1.2 Type II. The portfolios shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. The portfolios shall be separated, in groups of four or six, by the use of cells or partitions made of corrugated fiberboard material. Each packaged box shall be closed and waterproof sealed with tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I. Twelve portfolios shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, class domestic, with a burst test or not less than 200 p.s.i. The portfolios shall be separated in the box into groups of six (6) each by the use of corrugated fiberboard cells or partitions. Each box shall be closed, sealed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2.2 Type II. Twelve portfolios shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, with a burst test of not less than 200 p.s.i. The portfolios shall be separated in the box into groups of six (6) each by the use of corrugated fiberboard cells or partitions. Each box shall be closed, sealed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The portfolios shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Type I. The portfolios, packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, V3c, style RSC. The packed boxes shall be sealed, closed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.1.2 Type II. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the portfolios packaged as specified in 5.1.2.2, shall not require additional packing for shipment. When specified (see 6.2), the packaged portfolios shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636; class weather resistant, V3c, style RSC. The packed boxes shall be sealed, closed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I. Six packages of portfolios, packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1, shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, style RSC. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2.2 Type II. The portfolios shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

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5.2.3 Level C. The portfolios shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The portfolios are intended for general use by Government agencies in carrying documents, official papers, and the like.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class of portfolio required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Size of portfolio, where applicable (see 1.2.2).
(d) Color of portfolio (see 3.2.1.3 and 3.2.2.3).
(e) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Additional packing required for type II, level A (see 5.2.1.2).
(g) Whether special marking is required (see 5.3).

NO OFFICIAL DOD INTEREST HAS BEEN REGISTERED

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

User activity:

Army-GL

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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